7 New Connections

When an application for a new water connection to the KGWS network is received the following procedure is followed;

1. A technical assessment is performed to determine the feasibility of supplying the property with a water connection and an estimation of the costs is calculated.
2. Upon completion of the technical assessment there is one of two possible outcomes;
    a. A connection is deemed feasible and the applicant is invited to complete an application form to KGWS.
    b. A connection is deemed unfeasible and the request is rejected.
3. Application forms are reviewed by the Committee and may be awarded or rejected subject to considerations by the Committee.
4. If the application is successful, work can commence as soon as the applicant has paid the accompanying fee.

The application forms for new connections are available from Michael Coughlan, Manager KGWS. He can be contacted by email at killonegws@gmail.com or via the GWS phone 087 245 5253.

The following standard connection fees apply to applications;

Type	Standard Connection Fee
Agricultural	€300
Domestic	€1100

Note: The standard connection fees are subject to additional costs should extra parts and/or labour be required to suit the specific requirements of the work above the usual requirements of a standard connection.

1. Technical Assessment

When conducting a technical assessment the following considerations are taken into account.

1.1 Water Pressure

22 p.s.i (1.5 bar) is recommended at the water meter. Since the KGWS network relies on gravity to distribute water, the elevation of a proposed site is of particularly important consideration for feasibility of supply. Areas of high elevation within the network are subject to significant daily variations in water pressure. The reservoir is

an elevation of approximately 74 meters above sea level. Any sites of similar elevation will not receive adequate pressure. A screw-in barometer can be inserted in a meter box to check the pressure of the supply if there is a pre-existing connection nearby.



Figure 1. Screw in barometer for meter boxes.

1.2 Water Volume

Request an estimation from the applicant as to the volume of water expected to be consumed at the property. The volume consumed at a typical KGWS domestic connection is known by calculating the averages across previous meter readings. However, if the applicant will have an unusually higher demand, due to commercial/light industrial activity, this must be considered in accordance with the capacity of KGWS production.

1.3 Machinery

Should heavy machinery be required to expose the main, restrictions to access for heavy machinery must be considered.

1.4 Road Crossing

If the water main is on the opposite side of the road to the proposed site, a road opening license may be necessary. KGWS does not hold such a license. A qualified sub contractor is hired in this instance and the additional cost is conferred on the applicant.

1.5 Private Roads

It is standard procedure to lay water mains along public roads and to fit water meters outside the boundaries of private property. Should an applicant request a connection to a site/dwelling that is located on a private road then relevant permissions must be arranged between the applicant and the owner of the private road.

As with all KGWS water connections, the KGWS member is responsible for pipework on the consumer side of the meter box i.e from the property up to the meter box. Therefore, permission to lay piping on the private road is the responsibility of the applicant to obtain.

Note: Applicants are to be informed that works required to lay piping on private land is *their responsibility*. KGWS is not responsible for any construction works on private property nor is it responsible for the maintenance of water pipes on private property.

2. Tenants

KGWS does not provide water connections to tenants nor does it invoice tenants. Successful applications are **only granted to the owner of a property**, in whose name the relevant KGWS account is placed.

It is the property owner (KGWS account holder) who becomes the sole party responsible for water consumption through the meter. Invoices are only sent to this property owner. Should a successful applicant be granted permission to join the scheme, the property is to be connected to the water main via **one single meter box,** irrespective of whether;

- The property owner leases the property to a tenant,
- Multiple dwellings and/or businesses are on the site of the property.

3. Planning Permission – Letter of Consent of Supply

Applicants should contact KGWS during their planning application for a new dwelling. A letter from a group water scheme confirming the schemes consent to provide a water supply can be requested. If so;

- Perform a technical assessment.
- If a connection is feasible request the application fee to be paid.
- Upon receipt of the application fee, forward the letter of consent of supply to the applicant.
- If planning permission is rejected the applicant is entitled to a full refund.

4. Welcome Letter

When a new member has joined the scheme a welcome letter is posted to them. The welcome letter contains some basic information for members. The welcome letter is also posted when a pre-existing KGWS account has been transferred to a new owner following the sale of a property.